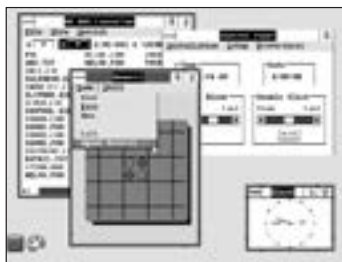


Windows 2.0 evolved to Windows/386, which was the same, only it used the 386 Microprocessor's *Enhanced Mode*, giving Windows the ability to run each application as a *Virtual Machine* with access to most of the system's memory rather than dividing up memory across applications.



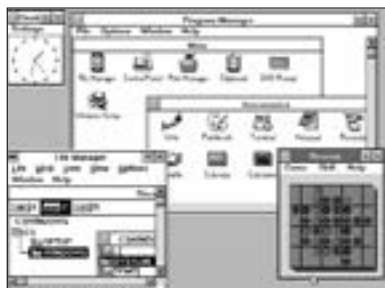
Windows 2.0 - suspiciously like Mac OS

The better look, though, looked too much like the Mac OS, and before they could blink, Apple came after Microsoft with accusations of violating their licensing agreement. A four-year court battle ensued, at the end of which Microsoft won its case.

Third time lucky—Windows 3.0

After the first faltering steps, Windows gained huge popularity in its third version, released in May 1990. It came with a prettier 16-colour interface, and new technical bells and whistles that let it make better use of the memory management capabilities that Intel had put in its 286 and 386 processors. Even if you had a lesser processor than the 286, Windows 3.0 would still support it, albeit without added features such as virtual memory.

Windows 3.0 was faster than the previous versions, and finally asserted the PC as a worthy competitor to the Apple Macintosh. The biggest thing to happen to Windows was the support it received from other application developers. More and more programs were written for Windows, giving more users a reason to invest in it.



Everything started from the Program Manager in Windows 3.0